

# Advanced Chord Vocabulary

## Major and Minor Triads and Arpeggios

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Advanced Lessons · Mixed Styles

# What is Triad in music?

Triads are the basic building blocks of chords, consisting of a root, a third, and a fifth.

## Major Triad

*Root, Major Third, Perfect Fifth*

**Example: C – E – G**

Sound: Happy

## Minor Triad

*Root, Minor Third, Perfect Fifth*

**Example: C – E $\flat$  – G**

Sound: Sad / Moody

## Diminished Triad

*Root, Minor Third, Diminished Fifth*

**Example: C – E $\flat$  – G $\flat$**

Sound: Tense / Unstable

## Augmented Triad

*Root, Major Third, Augmented Fifth*

**Example: C – E – G $\sharp$**

Sound: Dreamy / Suspenseful



Watch First

# What is a Triad?



**Triads Explained**

[Click Here \(19min 7 secs\)](#)

# What is an Arpeggio on Guitar?

## DEFINITION

Notes of a chord played one after another.

## PURPOSE

Highlight chord tones individually — crucial for soloing and melodic playing.

## TECHNIQUE

Commonly played using alternate picking or sweep picking on the guitar.

## TYPES

Simple triad arpeggios or extended to include 7ths (4 notes) or 9ths (5 notes).

*Arpeggios are the melodic expression of chords — the bridge between rhythm and lead guitar.*



Watch First

# Arpeggios on Guitar



**Arpeggio Guitar Short**

[Click Here](#)

# Difference Between Triads and Arpeggios

*The difference is not in the notes — but in how they are played.*

## Triad

Three notes played TOGETHER as a chord.

Example: C – E – G strummed simultaneously.

Used for: Rhythm guitar and outlining harmony.

## Arpeggio

The SAME notes played one after another.

Example: C ... E ... G played in sequence.

Used for: Melodic lines and soloing.

**Analogy:** A triad is a spelled word — an arpeggio is spelling that same word out loud.

[Triads vs Arpeggios](#)



[Click Here](#)

# Activity

- 1 Recount 5 Box shapes of CAGED System using C major
- 2 Play these 5 Box Shapes with First 3 strings Triads then Arpeggio
- 3 Play a Chord Progression C, Am F, G. Students Rotate to Use Triads then Arpeggio
- 4 Use alternate picking now for both
- 5 Play a C major arpeggio using sweep picking

# Homework — Lesson 2

DUE NEXT CLASS

## The Task

### PLAY BACKING TRACK

Use the YouTube videos provided

### RECORD YOUR PLAYING

1.5 to 2 minutes with the backing track

### SUBMIT

Guitar Class App → My Page → Submit



**VIDEO 1 — D A Bm G**

[Click Here](#)



**VIDEO 2 — Am G Dm E7**

[Click Here](#)



**Thank You!**